



Samsung's Blue Earth phone is a 3.5G full-touch handset that sports a solar panel



X4 flash!

Sandisk ships world's first X4-based memory card. The X4 technology can hold twice as many cells as traditional NAND chips

Bazaar

Creative Inspire T6160

Surprise punch

This is the latest 5.1 channel speaker offering from Creative's stables. However, this diminutive audio device acquired quite a few double takes. Let's look at the physical attributes and build first. The wires for the rear satellites are adequately long, while the ones for the front pair were a tad short. The volume control is on a wired remote dial similar to the older Creative Inspire systems like the 5200, except for the bass control, which is located on the back panel of the subwoofer. This is quite a pain since most of us don't have perfectly normalised files and have to reach for the bass control almost as often as the volume knob. The T6160 speaker system is positioned as a gaming and movie entertainment device. Still, what else is a good speaker for, if not music? So

we brought out our Creative Audigy 2 Platinum soundcard and gave it a thorough run with tracks from various genres, before moving on to the games and movies. The sound quality was unexpectedly good, especially the highs. The mids were slightly suppressed and instrument separation started dropping in the more instrument heavy tracks. Bass was quite tight and while being more powerful than we expected considering the RMS rating and size of the downward-firing subwoofer, it could've been better. The speakers retained clarity without distortion till about 70 per cent up its volume spectrum, which is quite good for a speaker system in



this range. Coming to movies and games, the rumble of the theatre and the location-based sounds of games were rendered quite well. Overall, a worthy contender if you're shopping for an entry-level 5.1 system.

Contact

Compuage Infocom Ltd
Phone : +91-92233 25430
Email: vinod.thakkar@compuageindia.com
Web site : http://in.creative.com
Price : Rs. 4,999

Specifications

Power: 6 Watts RMS satellites
20 Watts RMS subwoofer
Frequency response: 40Hz ~ 20kHz
SNR: >75dB

RATINGS

Features.....	6
Performance.....	7
Build quality.....	6.5
Value for money	7
Overall	7

WD TV Mini Media Player

A tiny digital media player

The WD TV mini is a tiny media player that connects to your TV and plays media from any USB storage medium. Unlike its elder brother, the WD TV HD, the mini does not sport an HDMI port. On connecting it to our full HD LCD TV, it automatically detected the optimal resolution. The interface looks cool and is fairly responsive. The nifty search feature lets you key in the file that you're looking for. We are happy to report that NTFS formatted storage is supported. The bundled remote is comfortable to use; but sadly, there is no separate volume control, so you'll need to use the



TV's remote for the same. To test the device, we threw a variety of encoded video files at it, and it played most of them perfectly. One of its features is upscaling typical videos to 1080i resolution. Comparatively, the difference in quality is not as good when up-scaled. But overall, we were pretty happy with the video quality. What

it could not play were high-definition video files (720p resolution and above), but that's what differentiates it from its elder cousin, the WD TV HD. Music as well as photos played without a hitch. Its file management menu lets you copy-paste and delete files on the connected drive.

At Rs. 6,000, the WD Mini is way overpriced. Its functionality can be served by any sub-Rs. 3,000 DivX-compatible DVD player with a USB port. We would have recommended it, had the price been around half of that.

Contact

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Phone: +91-93210 29204
Email: amarjeet.singh@wdc.com
Web site: www.wdc.com
Price: Rs 6,000

Specifications

Video: AVI (Xvid, MPEG1/2/4), MPG/MPEG, VOB, MP4/MOV (MPEG4), RM or RMVB 8/9/10
Photo: JPEG, GIF, TIFF, BMP, PNG
Audio: MP3, WAV/PCM/LPCM, WMA, AAC, FLAC, MKA, OGG, APE
Interface: Component A/V, Composite A/V, USB 2.0, S/PDIF

RATINGS

Features.....	6.5
Performance.....	7.5
Build quality.....	7
Value for money	4
Overall	6.5